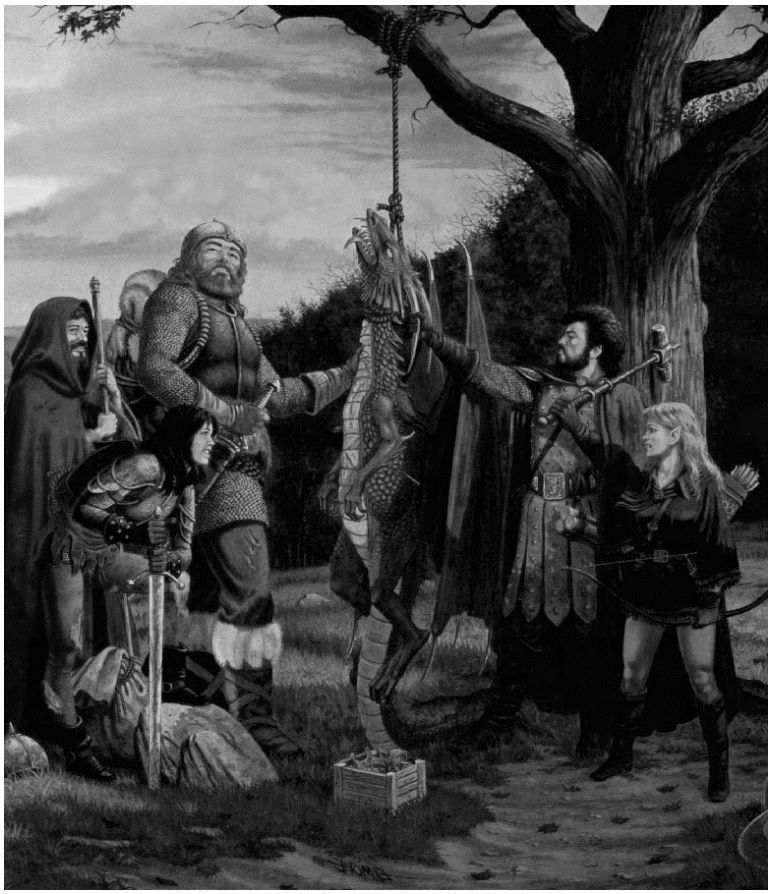
Dungeons & Dragons®

Mini-Game Expansion

StoryTelling System

Automate the Adventure Path



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INTRODUCTION

Welcome to the Mini-Game Expansion, a rules expansion for D&D 4E. The goals of this expansion are to introduce house rules that improve the existing game, and to add new rules that streamline and automate the game. For example, the DMG has suggestions for how to run skill challenges, as well as ideas for terrain rules in a combat encounter. This expansion standardizes those choices to help players become familiar with each routine, and to make the game faster. It consist of three rule books: House Rules, StoryTelling System, and World Builder's Guide.

The House Rules book starts by defining the core rules that the expansion uses from the published rules set. It goes on to the custom character creation guide which uses the new rules provided in this expansion for weapons and feats. It standardizes the combat setup routine as well as the post-combat looting, greatly increasing the value of skills. Even further, it provides entirely new types of combat, such as the trapped area and the chase.

The StoryTelling System book introduces a new framework for standardizing and automating the adventuring tasks which are known as the *party actions*. For each task, such as purchasing magic items or traveling cross-country, a complete set of rules is provided so that players can run the task themselves. This frees up the DM so their role becomes general oversight, and not micro-management. Additionally, there are the *weekly quests*, which are randomly generated mini-quests. They are repeatable and are also run by the players themselves - eliminating the need for the DM to create new storylines for every single game day. The routine tasks and weekly quests reinforce the fact that skills are as important as attack bonus, so just creating a power-game combat character is not enough to be successful in the course of the game.

The World Builder's Guide is designed to automate the creation of the campaign setting from the inside out. It start with a region, which sets the geography (mountains, seas, etc) and terrain (forest, swamp, etc). A region is populated with kingdoms, which are built by civilized races from the Monster Manual. Kingdoms have a technology level, religion, factions, and settlements. Settlements provide the different services and businesses that form the backdrop of the party action system. Additionally, there is an encounter group generator application on the website which is the best in the world.

CHAPTER ONE

GAME AUTOMATION

STORYTELLING FUNDAMENTALS

The most prominent feature of the Mini-Game Expansion (aka MGX) is the automation and standardization of all tasks related to adventuring. These tasks include traveling, combat, resting, buying magic gear, etc. In addition to the common party tasks, there are also templates for minor quests, a dungeon crawl, and an adventure module. All of these tasks and encounters are ordered in time with the use of *time blocks*. Skill challenges are standardized based on the guidelines provided by the DMG. There are also some house rules on resting and looting for further balance.

A NEW GAME FLOW

Board Game: Unlike a traditional RPG, the MGX works like a board game. Instead of the party being free to roam the world, they must choose their actions from a set number of options. That is, conventionally a party can do anything – travel in any direction, talk to anyone, etc. However, in this system the party's actions are limited to the pre-established tasks known as party actions.

Party Action: A *party action* is a standardization of something that an adventuring party would do. It has an objective, a time frame, and an outcome for the party. For example, visiting the town merchants takes 3 hours and allows any player to purchase mundane items. The basic actions, such as traveling on roads or resting, are straight forward and typically just require some payment. More complex actions, such as haggling for magic items or opening secret doors, require a skill challenge to determine the degree of success achieved. Encounters can be thought of as the next tier of this system, now involving turn-based mechanics and party rewards.

Taking Actions: The party action is so-called because the entire party does it together. That is, players do not have the option of going off by themselves and doing their own thing.

The gaming group elects a representative to be the time-keeper. This person uses the "Party Action Roster" available on the website to record the party's actions. The time-keeper should record as much detail as possible. For example, quest name, task success or failure, etc. The time-keeper keeps a record that the entire gaming group can use as a reference from one session to another.

To take an action, the party first weighs their options and discusses them. Once they decide what to do, the time keeper records it and the action is played out. Many actions can be entirely taken care of by the players without DM intervention.

Time Blocks: *Time blocks* are used to structure the passage of time in the game. The day is divided into 8 time blocks of 3 hours as shown in the next table. Each party action takes 1 or more time blocks to accomplish. For example, resting requires 2 time blocks (which is 6 hours, as per PHB 263).

Time-Block Definition

Time Block	Hours	Tropical Summer	Subtropical Autumn	Temperate Winter	Arctic Winter
1	0am – 3am	Night	Night	Night	Night
2	3am – 6am	Night	Night	Night	Night
3	6am – 9am	Day	Night	Night	Night
4	9am – 12am	Day	Day	Day	Night
5	0pm – 3pm	Day	Day	Day	Night
6	3pm – 6pm	Day	Day	Day	Night
7	6pm – 9pm	Day	Day	Night	Night
8	9pm – 12pm	Night	Night	Night	Night

ADVENTURING HOUSE RULES

This heading covers the type of rules that are found in PHB Chapter 8 "Adventuring". They either modify existing rules, or create new rules altogether.

Rest & Recovery: There are drastically different rules for resting in this system. They are covered in the "Take a Rest" action.

Loot Encounter: There are drastically different rules for looting an encounter in this system. They are covered in "House Rules" book under "Challenge: Encounter Rewards".

Delayed Character: A character that is delayed cannot participate in any party actions during their delay. The only action available to them is being delayed.

Hidden Character Sheet: Players should keep specific information about their characters hidden. The character's class and trained skills are public information so the party can plan properly. However, the character level, attribute values, and skill bonuses should remain hidden.

Skill Challenges

Skill Challenges: Skill challenges are modified from the description in DMG 72. The general guidelines still apply and these rules make the challenges more concrete. A skill challenge has the following components:

- Skills: The list of skills that can be used in the challenge. If multiple skills are listed, then a character that is rolling can choose one of the skills.
- Roller Type: Representative. Only 1 character chosen by the party rolls the challenge. The results apply to the whole party, or to the situation at hand.
- Roller Type: Individual. Each character must roll the challenge by themselves. The results apply just to the rolling character.
- Complexity: The number of successes before failures that must be rolled.
- Difficulty Class: The DC of the challenge is referenced in the "Level Lookup Table". It is based on the situation at hand. For example: "By encounter level", or "By settlement level".
- Faction: The rolling character's faction value for any faction type listed applies as a skill modifier to the challenge.
- Results: "S" refers to the number of successes achieved. "F" refers to the number of failures.
- Effects: The corresponding effect based on the challenge's results.

Skill Challenge: Example

Skills:	Skill 1, or Skill 2
Type:	Representative
Complexity:	2 successes before 2 failures
DC:	By settlement level
Faction:	-

Results	**Effects**
0 S, 2 F	Very bad
1 S, 2 F	Medium bad
2 S, 1 F	No change
2 S, 0 F	Pretty good

Skill Cooperation: The standard rules are at PHB 179. Those rules are overridden by these rules. First some definitions: the character rolling the skill challenge is the *roller*, and the character assisting is the *helper*. Some skills challenges may not be assisted, and this will be noted in the challenge's description.

To be a helper, a character must be trained in the skill being used in the challenge. A helper provides a skill +2 bonus to the roller. The bonus applies to all rolls of the skill challenge. If the roller type is Representative, then at most 2 characters may be helpers. If the roller type is individual, then no helpers are allowed.

Campaign Events

Campaign events are automated events that the DM orchestrates. There are two types: random and historic. Random events are things that happen to the party, these can be beneficial or detrimental. Historic events affect the campaign world, like change in a settlement's population, or the opening of a new business.

In the board game Descent, the game master accumulates threat points and uses those point to summon monsters and play effects. The campaign events serve a similar purpose, without being limited by threat points.

Random Event

Create Events: At the beginning of the week, before time block 1 on Sunday, the DM creates the random events of that week. First, roll 5d10, each result of a 7+ adds 1 random event to the week. Second, for each event roll it's day and time block on the next tables. The DM keeps the event information hidden from the players. The event type is created when the event actually happens.

Random Event Date-Time

Roll 1d8	Day
1	Sunday
2	Monday
3	Tuesday
4	Wednesday
5	Thursday
6	Friday
7	Saturday
8	Re-roll

Roll 1d8	Time Block
1	1
2	2
3	3
4	4
5	5
6	6
7	7
8	8

Trigger An Event: When the time comes the DM announces the random event and the players generate the event type. The DM announces the random event after the party has decided upon and recorded their action on the calendar. The event interrupts and cancels their current action. The event takes 1 time-block, unless otherwise stated.

To get the type, the party must make a Karma Challenge. Then use the results as a modifier for rolling on the Event Table. Once the event is known, the DM decides if it makes sense to actually happen, or if something must be changed or canceled. For example, if the party is on travel on a road and meet a travelling salesman, that makes sense. But if they meet a salesman while asleep in their house, then the DM can move the event to when they first wake up. Also, events can't occur when the party is in a dungeon.

Karma Challenge

Skills:	Insight, Streetwise, Religion
Type:	Representative
Complexity:	2 successes before 2 failures
DC:	By environment level
Faction:	

Results	**Effect**
0 S, 2 F	Roll -25
1 S, 2 F	Roll -10
2 S, 1 F	Roll +10
2 S, 0 F	Roll +10 or +20, player choice

Event Table

Roll 1d100	**Event**
1 - 10	Combat
11 - 16	Robbed
17 - 22	Vivid Nightmares
23 - 28	Price of Progress
29 - 35	Noxious Fumes
36 - 42	Recurring Injury
43 - 50	Fool's Errand
51 - 58	Festival
59 - 66	Bonus Bounty
67 - 72	Dungeon Map
73 - 78	Adventure Begins
79 - 88	Travelling Salesman
89 - 94	In Your Honor
95 - 100	Chosen of the Gods

Combat: The quintessential random encounter. This is a normal combat encounter, where each group is not particularly aware of each other. The level of the encounter is equal to the level of the current location - this can be a settlement, domain, etc. The monster group is random but should make sense with the location. Settlements typically have alliance, mercenary, horde, constructs. Wilderness close to civilization has lycanthropes, monstrous humanoids, undead. Further out in wilderness is beast, plants, dragons, faeries. Underground has beasts, aberrants, and elementals.

Robbed: The party is caught in a big crowd or distracting situation. Once they realize they are being robbed, it's too late to do much of anything. Each character loses a magic item, but rolls a challenge to mitigate the robbery.

Resist Robbery Challenge

Skills:	Arcana, Stealth
Type:	Individual
Complexity:	2 successes before 2 failures
DC:	By environment level
Faction:	

Results	Item Stolen
0 S, 2 F	Random item, re-roll if lowest level item
1 S, 2 F	Random item, re-roll if highest or lowest level item
2 S, 1 F	Lose lowest level item
2 S, 0 F	Choose item

Vivid Nightmares: The party is assailed by a supernatural force that holds them hostage mentally. It drains their life force. Each character rolls a challenge to resist the nightmarish effects. The effect removes some XP from the characters. If the character loses enough XP to go down a level, the character simply remains at their level.

Resist Nightmares

Skills:	Religion, Intimidate
Type:	Individual
Complexity:	2 successes before 2 failures
DC:	By environment level
Faction:	Commoner

Results	Value Lost
0 S, 2 F	M-XP x 120%
1 S, 2 F	M-XP x 80%
2 S, 1 F	M-XP x 50%
2 S, 0 F	M-XP x 25%

Price of Progress: The party suffers debt, pick pocketing, taxes, overcharge … something not good. Each character rolls a challenge to resist having their money taken. The character either loses the amount of money rolled, or all their money, whichever happens first.

Resist Prices

Skills:	Perception, Thievery
Type:	Individual
Complexity:	2 successes before 2 failures
DC:	By environment level
Faction:	Nobility

Results	Value Lost
0 S, 2 F	M-Gold x 120%
1 S, 2 F	M-Gold x 80%
2 S, 1 F	M-Gold x 50%
2 S, 0 F	M-Gold x 25%

Noxious Fumes: The party is exposed to infectious materials, air or liquid-borne. They must roll a challenge to avoid contracting a random disease of the environment's level.

Resist Fumes

Skills:	Endurance, Athletics
Type:	Individual
Complexity:	1 success before 1 failure
DC:	By environment level
Faction:	

Results	Effect
0 S, 1 F	No disease contracted
1 S, 0 F	Disease contracted

https://oneinchsquare.net/2010/07/23/a-comprehensive-list-of-diseases-in-4th-edition/

Recurring Injury: Old or recent war wounds start to act up and bother the party. Each character must roll to resist their recurring injuries. The healing surges lost to this effect can be recovered as normal.

Resist Injuries

Skills:	Heal, Nature
Type:	Individual
Complexity:	2 successes before 2 failures
DC:	By environment level
Faction:	

Results	Effect
0 S, 2 F	Lose 9 healing surges
1 S, 2 F	Lose 6 healing surges
2 S, 1 F	Lose 3 healing surges
2 S, 0 F	Lose 2 healing surges

Fool's Errand: The party wastes time pursuing something that turns out to be a complete waste of time. The party rolls to mitigate the effects, like a fake quest – minus the XP reward. The time delayed as a result of the challenge includes the default time block. That's the last time I drink and go whoring!

Resist Foolishness

Skills:	Streetwise, Insight
Type:	Representative
Complexity:	2 successes before 2 failures
DC:	By environment level
Faction:	

Results	Effect
0 S, 2 F	Party delayed by 9 time blocks
1 S, 2 F	Party delayed by 7 time blocks
2 S, 1 F	Party delayed by 5 time blocks
2 S, 0 F	Party delayed by 3 time blocks

Festival: It's holiday time or a prominent figure or circus is in town. The local economy is stimulated. All "Earn Income" rolls get skill +2 for the rest of the week.

Bonus Bounty: The party learns of a new bounty quest that they can choose to add to the list for this week or next week. The quest information is created with the normal process, except that instead of rolling, the party chooses the quest type, level, and faction. Also, all skill challenges, outside of encounters, get a skill +2 bonus.

Dungeon Map: The party is approached by an auspicious figure and offered a map for 100gp. The map shows a landmark on the region map which is the entrance to a dungeon. The party must "Travel in Wilderness" towards the landmark by using the map. Once they arrive at the general location, they must "Find Landmark" in order to actually find the dungeon entrance. The dungeon is a special kind of indefinitely running quest which is described in Chapter 4.

Adventure Begins: The party is introduced to a new adventure. The DM decides which adventure to run. This can be a pre-made adventure, or something custom written. The DM then gives the party the preliminary information. The Adventure Module is described in Chapter 5.

Travelling Salesman: The party is approached by an auspicious gentleman that offers them magic items for sale. The salesman offers a magic vendor's inventory, which is created with the rules "Visit Magic Vendor". The salesman is only available during this time block. Any character can switch one of their magic items with one of the vendor's items, provided that both items are the same level. The first item that the party buys is 50% reduced price.

In Your Honor: Tales of your deeds of bravery and service have spread far and why. The who-is-who of the town throw a banquet in your honor. Each character gets a gift of gold equal to S-XP x 80%.

Chosen of the Gods: The gods themselves have noticed your actions and reward you for following the path. Each character gets a gift of XP equal to S-XP x 80%.

Historic Event

historic events can affect the world:
- settlement property changes
- historical event, war
- wait until system stabilizes for this
- wait until paragon quests are made ?

CHAPTER TWO

THE PARTY ACTIONS

PARTY ACTIONS

TAKE A REST

New Rest Rules: These rules expand upon and overrule the *extended rest* core rules (PHB 263). To rest in a settlement, the party must be allowed to use the chosen location for rest. The party is by default allowed to rest in any inns and characters' houses. Both of these locations provide proper beds. To rest in the wilderness, use the "Setup Camp" party action. Additionally, the extended rest cooldown is extended from 12 hours to 18 hours (6 time blocks). It requires 2 time-blocks to take an extended rest.

Recovery: During an extended rest a character only recovers a limited number of healing surges, and not all of them. The number of surges recovered is based on the character's level and is shown on the next table. The number of healing surges recovered increases by +1 if the character uses a *proper bed*.

Recovery

PC Level	Surges per Rest
1 – 6	1
7 – 12	2
13 – 18	3
19 – 24	4
25+	All

Check-in to Inn

Check-in: To check into an inn, choose one of the inns in the settlement. It requires 1 time block. Typically the entire party is checked into the inn, but that is not necessary. The party must declare the number or characters that are checking in and the number of days. Payment is due for the entire stay before the stay can begin.

Stay: Characters that are checked in have a *stay* at the inn which provides benefits. When at the inn, the characters have some private rooms with enough proper beds for everyone. Also, the characters get a faction +2 bonus for the inn's faction within the settlement. The stay lasts through time-block 4 (12 noon) on the last day.

Inn Price

Inn Quality	Price/Night/Person
Poor	5 gp
Medium	10 gp
High	25 gp

VISIT COMMON MERCHANT

Description: The party visits street peddlers and reputable stores. They are looking for the best deals on commonly available items like weapons, armor and potions.

Requirements:

- The party must be in a settlement.
- It takes 1 time block, and can only be run during time-blocks 4 to 7.

Common Inventory: The common items available include mundane weapons and armor, as well as consumables. This list compiles everything available at the merchants.

- Weapons & Armor: Refer to "New Equipment" chapter in the "House Rules" book. Those rules override the core rules.
- Superior Implements: PHB3 195.
- Adventuring Gear: PHB 222, PHB2 197.
- Consumables: PHB 255. PHB3 213. Each character may purchase up to 1 of each type of consumable per visit to the merchants. The level of consumables available is limited to the settlement's level +4.
- Transportation Tickets: see the "Travel Modes" task.

Selling Items: Any mundane item can be sold for 50% of its value. Except for loot packets, which are sold at 100% value.

Earn Income

Description: The characters go off on their own to work their day jobs. These are the jobs where they learned their skills, and how they make a living outside of being adventurers.

Requirements:

- The party must be in a settlement.
- It takes 3 time blocks.
- It can only be run once per day.

Income: The base value of the income is the gold value of a monster of the settlement's level (aka S-Gold) as shown on the "Level Lookup Table".

Income Challenge

Skills:	Choose any skill. If the same skill is chosen as the last time for this action, there's a skill -5 penalty.
Type:	Individual
Complexity:	4 successes before 4 failures
DC:	By settlement level
Faction:	Industry
Special:	If you choose Bluff (Gambling) or History (Civil Engineering), then you get 1 re-roll, and the income is multiplied by 150%.

Results	Effect
4 S, 0 F	Earn S-Gold x 100%.
4 S, 1 F	Earn S-Gold x 80%.
4 S, 2 F	Earn S-Gold x 60%.
4 S, 3 F	Earn S-Gold x 40%.
3 S, 4 F	No effects.
2 S, 4 F	Lose 2 healing surges.
1 S, 4 F	Lose S-Gold x 10%. Lose 4 healing surges.
0 S, 4 F	Lose S-Gold x 25%. Lose 6 healing surges.

Travel Modes

Description: The party must often travel cross-country. This means any kind of movement that goes from one location to another on the region map. The locations are typically different settlements, but can also be wilderness locations such as a dungeon. This task is only about choosing the party's cross-country mode of travel for any particular trip. To actually travel, refer to the "Travel by Road" and "Travel in Wilderness" party actions.

Walking: Walking is the most basic travel mode. The party's travel speed is the average of the party's speed.

Horses: Horses are available for purchase in a settlement that has a stable service. A horse costs 500 gold and is purchased with all the same rules as a mundane item (see "Visit Common Merchant" above). Each horse requires 1 time-block a week for maintenance. The horse is fed, groomed, checked for ailments, has their horse shoes rotated, etc. If a horse is not maintained, they suffer a Speed -1 penalty.

Horses travel cross-country at their base speed of 10. Riding is a strenuous activity and characters may not take a rest while riding. A horse is a Riding Horse (MM 159) and is available in medium size for small characters. Horses are not available in encounters except for chases.

Boat Transport: Boats are available in settlements that border a river or coast. A boat ticket costs 10 gold per settlement level and is purchased with all the same rules as a mundane item (see "Visit Common Merchant" above). Boat tickets are one use only. Boats always leave at the start of time-block 3 (8am). They have Speed 16 and travel continuously to their destination. Boats have proper beds available.

Teleportation Circle: High-end settlements have teleportation circles available. A teleportation costs 50 gold per settlement level, plus 1000 gold to teleport between different planes. The destination must have a teleportation circle but does not need to be known by the travelers. It takes 1 time-block to purchase and use the teleportation service.

Travel by Road

Roads are noted on the region map. Traveling by road incurs no Speed penalty.

Travel In Wilderness

Traveling in wilderness requires a skill challenge to mitigate the Speed penalty. The Speed penalty varies based on the terrain being traversed.

SETUP CAMP

Overview: To take an extended rest while in wilderness, the party must setup camp. There are two issues relevant to setting up camp: having proper beds and avoiding a random encounter.

Setup Camp: The party has two choices for how to setup camp. After camp is setup, the DM rolls the chance for a random encounter.

- Proper Camp: The party takes 1 time-block to set up camp. There are proper beds setup and they get a skill +2 bonus to the skill challenge.
- Quick Camp: The party takes no time-blocks to setup camp and can start their extended rest immediately. There are no proper beds available.
- Settlement: If the party is close to a settlement or road, there is a skill -4 penalty to the skill challenge.

Setup Camp Challenge

Skills:	Stealth, Heal
Type:	Representative
Complexity:	2 successes before 2 failures
DC:	By wilderness level
Faction:	Militia

Results	**Effects**
2 S, 0 F	Random encounter chance 0%
2 S, 1 F	Random encounter chance 5%
1 S, 2 F	Random encounter chance 15%
0 S, 2 F	Random encounter chance 25%

Random Encounter: If a random encounter occurs, the party will be asleep except for the character on watch. The party must choose 4 characters to be on watch. The encounter happens during the watch of one of those characters at random. The encounter group level is given by the region's level on the next table. The character on watch is ready and can sound the alarm. Characters asleep can only start taking actions on the round after the alarm is sounded.

FIND LANDMARK

Description: While traveling cross-country, the party approaches their intended location. The job now is to actually find the landmark in the wilderness. This isn't a simple task, because the map doesn't include this much detail.

Requirements:

- The party must have a map or equivalent knowledge of the landmark.
- It takes 1 time block.
- It can only be run once per day.

Navigation: First, the party must travel cross-country to the vicinity of the landmark. They can travel by any means they choose. Once at the area, the party must find/open the entrance. To find and use the landmark, roll the following challenge.

Landmark Challenge

Skills:	Perception, Arcana
Type:	Representative
Complexity:	2 successes before 2 failures
DC:	By landmark level
Faction:	Shadow

Results	**Effects**
2 S, 0 F	Landmark found.
2 S, 1 F	Landmark found.
1 S, 2 F	Landmark not found.
0 S, 2 F	Landmark not found.

VISIT MAGIC VENDOR

Description: In the MGX the combat rewards are modified and magic item drops are extremely rare. Instead, the ways to get magic items are by visiting this business and the Enchanter. The magic vendor has an inventory that changes every week. The inventory is randomly generated by the players. The vendor can sell or buy magic items.

Requirements:

- The party must choose 1 magic vendor in the current settlement.
- It takes 1 time block, and can only be run during time blocks 4 to 7.
- The inventory can only be generated once per week.

Buy Items: Characters may buy any number of items during a visit. The characters can only purchase items that are in this week's inventory. Every purchase is subject to a Haggle Challenge.

Sell Items: Characters may sell any number of items during a visit. The item's level must be less than or equal to the vendor's level +2. The item's base sale value is 50% of the standard purchase value (not 10% as in DMG). Every sale is subject to a Haggle Challenge.

Haggle Challenge: The haggle challenge is used to modify the price of a magic item transaction. Before rolling, the character must commit to the trade. That is, regardless of the results of the challenge, the character must proceed with the trade.

Haggle Challenge

Skills:	Diplomacy, Intimidate
Type:	Representative
Complexity:	2 successes before 2 failures
DC:	By vendor's level
Faction:	The vendor's faction

Results	Effects
2 S, 0 F	Buy price 75%, sell price 125%
2 S, 1 F	Buy price 100%, sell price 100%
1 S, 2 F	Buy price 125%, sell price 75%
0 S, 2 F	Buy price 150%, sell price 50%

Inventory: The vendor's inventory is created by the players when they visit a vendor, unless that vendor already has an inventory for the current week. The party can create the inventory and purchase any items they wish as part of the time block spent at the vendor. The inventory has 1 copy of each item. Any item can be purchased until the inventory expires which is every Saturday at the end of the last time block.

Generate Inventory: To generate the magic item inventory follow these steps.

1] Magic Vendor Roster: Prepare the inventory roster by entering the settlement's name, week date (week/month/year), and the vendor information.

2] Number of Items: The number of items in the vendor's inventory is 8.

3] Rule Book: Determine the rule book to be used for generating all items of the inventory. Note that determining the rule book comes before determining the item types because it's easier to be able to reference just one book, as opposed to having items from multiple books.

Rule Book

Roll 1d10	Book
1 – 6	PHB 1
7 – 8	PHB 2
9 – 10	PHB 3

4] Item Types: For each item in the inventory, determine its base type by rolling on the next table. The number in parenthesis is the page number in the respective book.

PHB 1	
1d20	**Item Type**
1 – 3	Weapon (232)
4	Holy S. (237)
5	Orb (239)
6	Rod (240)
7	Staff (241)
8	Wand (243)
9 – 12	Armor (228)
13	Arms Slot (245)
14	Feet Slot (246)
15	Hands Slot (247)
16	Head Slot (248)
17 – 18	Neck Slot (250)
19	Ring (251)
20	Waist Slot (252)

PHB 2	
1d20	**Item Type**
1 – 8	Armor (198)
9 – 11	Weapon (203)
12 – 14	Rod (205)
15 – 16	Staff (206)
17 – 20	Totem (207)

PHB 3	
1d20	**Item Type**
1 – 4	Armor (197)
5 – 8	Weapon (200)
9 – 12	Ki Focus (203)
13 – 15	Orb (206)
16 – 19	Staff (209)
20	Ring (213)

5] Roll Enchantments: This step requires the player to create a temporary table to roll on. First, count the number of enchantments available to the item type that are within 2 levels of the vendor's level on the item type's table. Second, roll a die that has enough sides to be able to roll any of the enchantments. Each enchantment has a chance of 1, and any rolls outside the table are re-rolled.

For example, say the rule book is PHB 1, the vendor's level is 4, and the current item type is magic armor. Therefore the temporary table consists of all magic armors level 2 to 6 in PHB 228. There are 2 at level 2, 5 at level 3, 3 at level 4, 5 at level 5, and 1 at level 6 for a total of 16 enchantments. Therefore you roll 1d20 and use that number as the item number. So a roll of 4 is the 2nd level 3 item. A roll of 17-20 has to be re-rolled.

6] Item Category: Some magic items have multiple base item categories, like how a weapon can be mace, hammer, flail, etc. For such items, the purchasing character chooses a base item that's within the categories available.

VISIT ENCHANTER

Description: One of the characters hires a skilled craftsman to create a magic item customized for them. Unlike the magic vendor, the Enchanter provides 1 specific item that the character chooses.

Requirements:

- The party must choose 1 enchanter in the current settlement.
- The first and second visits take 1 time block, and can only be run during time blocks 4 to 7.
- The party may only purchase 1 magic item per week.

Order Item: On the first visit, the purchasing character tells the enchanter what they want. The player chooses any magic item that is available in the rule set. The item must be within 2 levels of the enchanter's level, above and below.

Pickup Item: After 24 hours, the item is available for pickup. At this point, payment is made and it's subject to a Haggle Challenge. There is a 150% price markup from the base value of the magic item, this factor is already figured in the Haggle Challenge.

Haggle Challenge: The haggle challenge is used to modify the price of a magic item transaction. Before rolling, the character must commit to the trade. That is, regardless of the results of the challenge, the character must proceed with the trade.

Haggle Challenge

Skills:	Diplomacy, Intimidate
Type:	Representative
Complexity:	2 successes before 2 failures
DC:	By enchanter's level
Faction:	The enchanter's faction

Results	**Effects**
2 S, 0 F	Buy price 110%
2 S, 1 F	Buy price 150%
1 S, 2 F	Buy price 190%
0 S, 2 F	Buy price 220%

VISIT SKINTRADER

Description: The Skintrader provides henchmen for the PCs. Henchmen can be hired mercenaries, or long time companions. This party action is for acquiring new henchmen. For the rules on how henchmen work, refer to "House Rules Chapter 2".

Requirements:

- The party must choose 1 skintrader in the current settlement.
- It takes 1 time block, and an additional time block if a hire is made.

Inventories: The skintrader has 2 inventories, 1 for mercenaries, and 1 for companions. Each inventory is created separately, but following similar rules. The party must randomly generate the inventories as described ahead. Both inventories expire at the end of the week (end of Saturday), at which point new inventories must be generated.

Hire A Henchman: To hire a henchman, a character must choose it from this week's inventory. The character must choose from the mercenary inventory, or the companion inventory. The price of a henchman is based on what type of henchman it is: mercenary is M-Gold x50%, companion is M-Gold x200%. Hiring a henchman is subject to a Haggle Challenge.

Haggle Challenge

Skills:	Diplomacy, Intimidate
Type:	Representative
Complexity:	2 successes before 2 failures
DC:	By enchanter's level
Faction:	The business' faction

Results	Effects
2 S, 0 F	Buy price 75%
2 S, 1 F	No change
1 S, 2 F	Buy price 125%
0 S, 2 F	Buy price 150%

Mercenary Inventory

1] Vendor Roster: Prepare the inventory roster by entering the settlement's name, the week, and the vendor's name.

2] Number of Mercenaries: The number of entries in the barrack's inventory is 4.

3] Generate Mercenaries: To randomly generate a monster, use the website's "Monster Tools / Encounter Group". Change the "Level" to the level of the Skintrader. Change "Type" to "Humanoid". Change "Ally Group" to "Alliance" or "Mercenary". Then run the encounter generator. Add the randomly generated "Primary" monster to the inventory.

Companion Inventory

1] Vendor Roster: Prepare the inventory roster by entering the settlement's name, the week, and the vendor's name.

2] Number of Companions: The number of entries in the trainer's inventory is 4.

3] Generate Companions: To randomly generate a monster, use the website's "Monster Tools / Encounter Group". Change the "Level" to the level of the Skintrader. Change "Type" to "Beast, MagicalB". Then run the encounter generator. Add the randomly generated "Primary" monster to the inventory.

Train Abilities

Description: The characters dedicate some time to honing their special abilities.

Requirements:

- The characters must use a dojo in the current settlement.
- It takes 3 time blocks.
- It can only be run once per week.

Train: Each character spends an amount of money of their choice, which is known as the *fee*. The character then makes a Lifeline Challenge and earns an XP award based on the results. The fee is limited to at most the gold value of a monster of the dojo's level.

Lifeline Challenge

Skills:	Str, Dex, Con, Int, Wis, Cha
Type:	Individual
Complexity:	2 successes before 2 failures
DC:	By business' level
Faction:	The business' faction

Results	**Effects**
2 S, 0 F	Fee x 100%
2 S, 1 F	Fee x 75%
1 S, 2 F	Fee x 50%
0 S, 2 F	Fee x 25%

CHAPTER THREE

BOUNTY QUESTS

OVERVIEW

The bounty quests are a set of automated minor quests. They are the simplest adventure path available in the MGX so they serve as a good introduction to the system. They are automated in that they follow the same template – 3 skill challenges followed by a combat. They are bounties in that the PC's know the monsters they're after, it's not a mystery to unravel, rather just a trail to follow to stop the villains.

Bounties List: Each settlement has a list of bounties that refreshes every week. This list is randomly generated by the players when they run "Search for Bounties". The players can then choose one of the quests on the list, and play it out. There's no limit to the number of bounties that can be pursued per week. However, the list expires at the end of Saturday, at which point it must be generated again for the next week.

Running A Bounty: To start a bounty, the party runs "Run Quest Task" on the bounty's Task 1. They then continue to run that action on the following tasks, until the "Final Fight" is revealed. Whether the party wins the bounty or not, they must run "Turn in Bounty" before starting another bounty.

Party Actions

Search for Bounties

The party searches for the bounties currently available in the settlement. They might hear rumors at a tavern, work with the local militia, help at the temple, check the bulletin board at city hall, etc.

Requirements

- The party must be in a settlement.
- It takes 1 time block.

Generate Quest List: The players create the bounty list for the current settlement. A bounty may be started in the time block after this.

1] Bounties Roster: Prepare the bounties roster by entering the settlement name, week date (week/month/year), and player name.

2] Quest Number: The number of quests available is given by a base number plus a modifier from a skill challenge. The base number is given by the size of the settlement. The minimum number of quests is 1.

- Burg: 2
- Town: 3
- Borough: 4
- City: 5
- Metropolis: 7

Bounty Search Challenge

Skills:	Streetwise, Insight
Roller:	Representative
Complexity:	2 successes before 2 failures
DC:	By settlement level
Faction:	

Results	Effects
0 S, 2 F	Number of quests -3
1 S, 2 F	Number of quests -1
2 S, 1 F	No change
2 S, 0 F	Number of quests +2

3] Quest Types: Create the quest properties for the number of quests available. A quest has a type and level, both of which are rolled on the following tables. Each quest also has a faction which is rolled on the domain's faction table.

Quest Type

Roll 1d8	Quest
1	Bandit's Run
2	Grand Theft Heirloom
3	Repel the Raiders
4	Animal Attack
5	Primal Predators
6	Necro Portal
7	Battle Vestige
8	Re-roll

Quest Level

Roll 2d6	Level
2 - 5	Settlement Level -1
6 - 8	Settlement Level
9 - 12	Settlement Level +1

DESIGN SIDEBAR

The quest level randomization was first done with a wider range of levels. This was changed to encourage the players to move around settlements more often.

Roll 2d10	Level
2 - 6	Settlement Level -2
7 - 9	Settlement Level -1
10 - 12	Settlement Level
13 - 15	Settlement Level +1
16 - 20	Settlement Level +2

Run Quest Task

The party uses this action to run each of the first three tasks of a quest. Success with the first task leads to the second one, and so on until the party gets to the final fight.

Requirements:

- The party does the next task for their currently chosen bounty.
- It takes 2 time blocks.

Task Challenge: The party rolls the next task challenge in the bounty quest. A task challenge has a primary and a secondary skill associated with it. The secondary skill takes a -2 penalty (as shown in the challenge breakdown). Before rolling the challenge, the player tells the story of what they are actually doing. It doesn't have to be fancy, just funny is just fine. The bounties' specific rules (skills used, results, etc) are found in the next section.

XP Award: The character rolling the challenge gets an XP award based on the results. If successful the award is Q-XP x 75%. If failed the award is Q-XP x 25%. Also, any character assisting the challenge gets Q-XP x 25%, regardless of the results.

Next Up: After the XP award the party action ends and the party gets different effects based on the results of the challenge. These effects shape which actions are available to the party in regards to the bounty. They are explained next.

<u>Task Success:</u> The challenge is passed and the party may go on to the next task, or do other things and then come back to the quest. If on task 3, the Final Fight is played out immediately following.

<u>Task Failure:</u> The challenge is failed but the party still has a chance to retry. The skills available for the retry will also be listed in the results. Only 1 retry can be taken per task.

<u>Quest Failure:</u> The challenge is failed and the quest is failed. The quest still needs to be turned in before another can be started.

<u>Delay Effect:</u> The time blocks required for the action are extended by the listed amount.

<u>Skill Modifier:</u> Provides a positive or negative modifier to the next task's challenge. If the nest task is combat, then it provides a modifier to the party's combat setup.

<u>Skip Task:</u> If on task 1, the next task becomes task 3. If on task 2, the next task becomes the final fight. If on task 3, the party gets Initiative +4.

Final Fight

Having passed all the previous tasks, the party is now face-to-face with the culprits. Winning this encounter also wins the quest.

Requirements:

- The party has triggered the final fight for their current bounty.
- It takes 1 time block.

Encounter: The final fight is a combat encounter with the monster type listed in the bounty's description. The combat level is determined on the next table.

Encounter Level

Roll 2d4	Level
2 – 4	Quest Level
5 – 6	Quest Level +1
7 – 8	Quest Level +2

Result: If the party wins all encounters of the final fight, they win the quest. Otherwise, they lose the quest. Either way, the quest must be turned in with "Turn In Bounty".

TURN-IN BOUNTY

Whether successful or not, the party turns in their current bounty. This must be done before another one can be started.

Requirements:

- The party must be in the bounty's settlement.
- It takes 1 time block.

Win Rewards

XP Award: Each character gets a gold award. The base value of the award is equal to the Gold value of a monster of the quest's level (aka Q-Gold). The total value is the base times a factor given by a Haggle Challenge.

Haggle Challenge

Skills:	Diplomacy, Intimidate
Type:	Representative
Complexity:	2 successes before 2 failures
DC:	By quest's level
Faction:	The quest's faction

Results	Effects
2 S, 0 F	Q-Gold x 100%
2 S, 1 F	Q-Gold x 75%
1 S, 2 F	Q-Gold x 50%
0 S, 2 F	Q-Gold x 25%

XP Award: Each character gets an XP award. The base value of the award is equal to the XP value of a monster of the quest's level (aka Q-XP). The total value is the base times a factor given by a Lifeline Challenge.

Lifeline Challenge

Skills:	Str, Dex, Con, Int, Wis, Cha
Type:	Individual
Complexity:	2 successes before 2 failures
DC:	By quest level

Results	Effects
2 S, 0 F	Q-XP x 100%
2 S, 1 F	Q-XP x 75%
1 S, 2 F	Q-XP x 50%
0 S, 2 F	Q-XP x 25%

Lose Rewards

XP Reward: Each character gets an XP reward. The value of the reward is Q-XP x 25%.

Faction Penalty: The last character that attempted a task of the quest loses 1 point in the quest's faction.

Bounty Rules

Bandit's Run

Prologue: Bandits have been raiding merchants on the road. They are quite good at ambushing caravans, even guarded ones. They steal as much as they can, with a preference for gold above all else. The silver lining is they don't make a point of killing everyone. It's difficult for the town guard to deal with them because they can strike anywhere along the road. However, the attacks seem to be clustered around a certain area or time of day. This allows the party to hatch a plan to stop these menaces to the local economy.

Task 1 – Survey Attack Site: The last attack happened recently and the survivors can guide the party to where it happened. The site has not been cleaned up yet, and might have some broken items, burned carriages, or corpses. If the challenge is successful, the party learns more about the bandits and can make plans to flush them out of hiding.

Task 1 Challenge

Skills:	Heal, History -2
Type:	Representative
Complex:	4 successes before 4 failures
DC:	By quest level

Results	Effects
4 S, 0 F	Task Success. Both skills +2.
4 S, 1 F	Task Success. Secondary skill +2.
4 S, 2 F	Task Success.
4 S, 3 F	Task Success. Delay by 1.
3 S, 4 F	Task Failed. Retry any skill.
2 S, 4 F	Task Failed. Retry other skill.
1 S, 4 F	Quest Failed.
0 S, 4 F	Quest Failed. Delay by 2.

Task 2 – Disguise Yourself: To provoke the bandits to attack, the party will disguise themselves as traveling merchants. The best disguise is one that can be quickly put together, but fools the bandits into thinking that the caravan has precious cargo and is inadequately defended. If successful, the party can take their disguise on the road.

Task 2 Challenge

Skills:	Bluff, Diplomacy -2
Type:	Representative
Complex:	4 successes before 4 failures
DC:	By quest level

Results	Effects
4 S, 0 F	Task Success. Secondary skill +2.
4 S, 1 F	Task Success.
4 S, 2 F	Task Success. Delay by 1.
4 S, 3 F	Task Success. Secondary skill -2.
3 S, 4 F	Task Failed. Retry any skill.
2 S, 4 F	Task Failed. Retry other skill.
1 S, 4 F	Quest Failed.
0 S, 4 F	Quest Failed. Delay by 2.

Task 3 – Counter Ambush: The party must be at the right place at the right time to draw out these robbers. It's a long shot, and may just require some dumb luck.

Task 3 Challenge

Skills:	Endurance, Nature -2
Type:	Representative
Complexity:	4 successes before 4 failures
DC:	By quest level

Results	**Effects**
4 S, 0 F	Task Success. Skip next task.
4 S, 1 F	Task Success. Primary skill +2.
4 S, 2 F	Task Success. Secondary skill +2.
4 S, 3 F	Task Success.
3 S, 4 F	Task Failed. Retry any skill.
2 S, 4 F	Task Failed. Retry other skill.
1 S, 4 F	Quest Failed.
0 S, 4 F	Quest Failed. Delay by 2.

Task 4 – Encounter: The monster ally group is alliance. The terrain is the biome of the settlement, with a road bisecting it.

GRAND THEFT HEIRLOOM

Prologue: Sometimes the dispossessed in society become robbers for thrills and to survive. A band of them has recently stolen a noble family's heirloom. The nobles are in an uproar over it, accusing and bickering among themselves. They are in no shape to pursue the robbers because the entire house guard was put into a long deep sleep. The heirloom is of no intrinsic value to the robbers, but it'll fetch a hefty price in a neighboring kingdom or from a shady buyer. The party must track them down and retrieve the object before they have fled the town.

Heirloom: An item of great importance to a particular noble house. It can be an art piece that decorates the home, a banner flown in battle, jewelry, or an ornamental weapon. Sometimes it's a magic item, in which case there is also an enchantment on it which only permits persons from the noble family to use it. The use of heirlooms pervades the entire planet, that is, many different races have the practice in their culture.

Task 1 – Win Their Trust: The nobles are very flustered and it's hard to get their attention to figure out what happened. You'll have to calm them down and get them to trust you. If successful, you'll know what heirloom was stolen and get some information about the robbers.

Task 1 Challenge

Skills:	Diplomacy, Insight -2
Type:	Representative
Complex:	4 successes before 4 failures
DC:	By quest level

Results	**Effects**
4 S, 0 F	Task Success. Skip next task.
4 S, 1 F	Task Success. Both skills +2.
4 S, 2 F	Task Success. Primary skill +2.
4 S, 3 F	Task Success. Secondary skill +2.
3 S, 4 F	Task Failed. Retry any skill.
2 S, 4 F	Task Failed. Retry other skill.
1 S, 4 F	Quest Failed.
0 S, 4 F	Quest Failed. Delay by 2.

Task 2 – Find the Camp: Based on what you know about the case, you can narrow down the likely location of the robber base. If successful, you find a building on the edge of town where the robbers have made camp.

Task 2 Challenge

Skills:	Streetwise, Perception -2
Type:	Representative
Complex:	4 successes before 4 failures
DC:	By quest level

Results	**Effects**
4 S, 0 F	Task Success. Secondary skill +2.
4 S, 1 F	Task Success.
4 S, 2 F	Task Success. Delay by 1.
4 S, 3 F	Task Success. Secondary skill -2.
3 S, 4 F	Task Failed. Retry any skill.
2 S, 4 F	Task Failed. Retry other skill.
1 S, 4 F	Quest Failed.
0 S, 4 F	Quest Failed. Delay by 2.

Task 3 – Raid Camp: Having found their camp, you now need a plan that allows you to attack and keep them cornered so they don't flee with the heirloom. Sneaking in is always a good option.

Task 3 Challenge

Skills:	Stealth, Acrobatics -2
Type:	Representative
Complexity:	4 successes before 4 failures
DC:	By quest level

Results	**Effects**
4 S, 0 F	Task Success. Secondary skill +2.
4 S, 1 F	Task Success.
4 S, 2 F	Task Success. Delay by 1.
4 S, 3 F	Task Success. Secondary skill -2.
3 S, 4 F	Task Failed. Retry any skill.
2 S, 4 F	Task Failed. Retry other skill.
1 S, 4 F	Quest Failed.
0 S, 4 F	Quest Failed. Delay by 2.

Task 4 – Encounter: The monster ally group is mercenaries. The terrain is Outskirts.

REPEL THE RAIDERS

Prologue: Raiders from the horde (orc, goblin, bugbear, etc) have invaded a nearby village. They are a small group, but highly skilled in battle. They've wiped out the village's defenses and are holed up in the town hall. Their goal is likely to just hold the village for a day, such a thing is often a clan initiation, or an otherwise chaotic display of power. They've probably already accomplished what they set out to do, so the party's goal is to avenge the dead villagers and kill the raiders so they don't come back.

Task 1 – Run to Village: The raiders won't linger in the village for too long. They know the cavalry is coming at some point. The party must hot-foot it to the village. If they fail, then they arrive too late and the horde has left.

Task 1 Challenge

Skills:	Athletics, Endurance -2
Type:	Representative
Complex:	4 successes before 4 failures
DC:	By quest level

Results	**Effects**
4 S, 0 F	Task Success.
4 S, 1 F	Task Success. Delay by 1.
4 S, 2 F	Task Success. Primary skill -2.
4 S, 3 F	Task Success. Both skills -2.
3 S, 4 F	Task Failed. Retry any skill.
2 S, 4 F	Task Failed. Retry other skill.
1 S, 4 F	Quest Failed.
0 S, 4 F	Quest Failed. Delay by 2.

Task 2 – The Fire: When you arrive at the village the massive raging fire at the grain silo immediately catches your attention. You run over and to your horror find that there are people deliberately trapped in the fire. You'll have to use the best craftsmanship you have to either stop the fire or find a way to get the villagers out. If successful, you save the villagers and learn where the horde is hiding.

Task 2 Challenge

Skills:	History, Dungeoneering -2
Type:	Representative
Complex:	4 successes before 4 failures
DC:	By quest level

Results	**Effects**
4 S, 0 F	Task Success. Skip next task.
4 S, 1 F	Task Success. Primary skill +2.
4 S, 2 F	Task Success. Secondary skill +2.
4 S, 3 F	Task Success.
3 S, 4 F	Task Failed. Retry any skill.
2 S, 4 F	Task Failed. Retry other skill.
1 S, 4 F	Quest Failed.
0 S, 4 F	Quest Failed. Delay by 2.

Task 3 – Provoke Them: The raiders are holed up in the town hall. They might have some hostages, and they have a pretty good escape plan. When you arrive they're sitting idle and not spoiling for a fight, they have the upper hand. You must goad them into fighting you. Insulting their mother might help.

Task 3 Challenge

Skills:	Intimidate, Bluff -2
Type:	Representative
Complexity:	4 successes before 4 failures
DC:	By quest level

Results	**Effects**
4 S, 0 F	Task Success. Skip next task.
4 S, 1 F	Task Success. Primary skill +2.
4 S, 2 F	Task Success. Secondary skill +2.
4 S, 3 F	Task Success.
3 S, 4 F	Task Failed. Retry any skill.
2 S, 4 F	Task Failed. Retry other skill.
1 S, 4 F	Quest Failed.
0 S, 4 F	Quest Failed. Delay by 2.

Task 4 – Encounter: The monster ally group is horde. The terrain is Downtown.

ANIMAL ATTACK

Prologue: A family of wild hunting beasts has been terrorizing and running off with livestock from different farms around town. The animals and the people are in shock, and the farmers depend on their animals for their livelihood. The town guard has investigated the attacks, but they came up with nothing. The hunters must have a dwelling outside of town. The attacks have been happening for a while, and it's time someone did something about it.

Task 1 – Speak with Farmers : There was a fresh new attack that fits the profile just a day ago. The farmers are really angry and are baffled the hunters got past their defenses. There's not a lot of physical evidence, but the farmer's kids saw the attack under cover of night. Altogether you should be able to gather enough clues to track the hunters.

Task 1 Challenge

Skills:	Insight, Streetwise -2
Type:	Representative
Complex:	4 successes before 4 failures
DC:	By quest level

Results	Effects
4 S, 0 F	Task Success. Skip next task.
4 S, 1 F	Task Success. Primary skill +2.
4 S, 2 F	Task Success. Secondary skill +2.
4 S, 3 F	Task Success.
3 S, 4 F	Task Failed. Retry any skill.
2 S, 4 F	Task Failed. Retry other skill.
1 S, 4 F	Quest Failed.
0 S, 4 F	Quest Failed. Delay by 2.

Task 2 – Track the Hunters: You pick up the trail of the hunters at the attack site. Now you must follow it to their lair.

Task 2 Challenge

Skills:	Perception, Nature -2
Type:	Representative
Complex:	4 successes before 4 failures
DC:	By quest level

Results	Effects
4 S, 0 F	Task Success. Both skills +2.
4 S, 1 F	Task Success. Secondary skill +2.
4 S, 2 F	Task Success.
4 S, 3 F	Task Success. Delay by 1.
3 S, 4 F	Task Failed. Retry any skill.
2 S, 4 F	Task Failed. Retry other skill.
1 S, 4 F	Quest Failed.
0 S, 4 F	Quest Failed. Delay by 2.

Task 3 – Set the Trap: The best way to deal with these beasts is to set a trap outside their lair. It's tricky because the trap must be set while they are inside the lair sleeping.

Task 3 Challenge

Skills:	Stealth, History -2
Type:	Representative
Complexity:	4 successes before 4 failures
DC:	By quest level

Results	**Effects**
4 S, 0 F	Task Success. Secondary skill +2.
4 S, 1 F	Task Success.
4 S, 2 F	Task Success. Delay by 1.
4 S, 3 F	Task Success. Secondary skill -2.
3 S, 4 F	Task Failed. Retry any skill.
2 S, 4 F	Task Failed. Retry other skill.
1 S, 4 F	Quest Failed.
0 S, 4 F	Quest Failed. Delay by 2.

Task 4 – Encounter: The monster ally group is animal. The terrain is the biome of the settlement.

PRIMAL PREDATORS

Prologue: Some other worldly horrors are tormenting the locals. They are nasty amorphous monsters that bite and eat people while they are still alive. Some people actually survive the attack, for a little while. To make matters worse, they've made their lair in the nearby mine/tunnels. This makes it exceptionally difficult to fight them, as they are at home in the underground.

Task 1 – Speak to Witnesses: These monsters strike whenever and wherever they want, day or night. They've left some witnesses of their attacks, as well as of the entrance of their lair. People are very scared of them and believe the monsters will hunt them down if they talk about them. You'll have to promise them that you'll stop the monsters to get them to talk.

Task 1 Challenge

Skills:	Diplomacy, Insight -2
Type:	Representative
Complex:	4 successes before 4 failures
DC:	By quest level

Results	Effects
4 S, 0 F	Task Success. Skip next task.
4 S, 1 F	Task Success. Primary skill +2.
4 S, 2 F	Task Success. Secondary skill +2.
4 S, 3 F	Task Success.
3 S, 4 F	Task Failed. Retry any skill.
2 S, 4 F	Task Failed. Retry other skill.
1 S, 4 F	Quest Failed.
0 S, 4 F	Quest Failed. Delay by 2.

Task 2 – Monster Tracks: With directions to the entrance of the monsters' lair, you quickly make your way over. The job now is to track the monsters in the underground and find their lair.

Task 2 Challenge

Skills:	Dungeoneering, Nature -2
Type:	Representative
Complex:	4 successes before 4 failures
DC:	By quest level

Results	Effects
4 S, 0 F	Task Success. Skip next task.
4 S, 1 F	Task Success. Primary skill +2.
4 S, 2 F	Task Success. Secondary skill +2.
4 S, 3 F	Task Success.
3 S, 4 F	Task Failed. Retry any skill.
2 S, 4 F	Task Failed. Retry other skill.
1 S, 4 F	Quest Failed.
0 S, 4 F	Quest Failed. Delay by 2.

Task 3 – Storm the Lair: You'll need some kind of distraction to spook and corral the monsters. You can try smoking them out, or building walls where they might escape.

Task 3 Challenge

Skills:	History, Stealth -2
Type:	Representative
Complexity:	4 successes before 4 failures
DC:	By quest level

Results	**Effects**
4 S, 0 F	Task Success.
4 S, 1 F	Task Success. Delay by 1.
4 S, 2 F	Task Success. Primary skill -2.
4 S, 3 F	Task Success. Both skills -2.
3 S, 4 F	Task Failed. Retry any skill.
2 S, 4 F	Task Failed. Retry other skill.
1 S, 4 F	Quest Failed.
0 S, 4 F	Quest Failed. Delay by 2.

Task 4 – Encounter: The monster ally group is hunter. The terrain is any underground.

NECRO PORTAL

Prologue: A roaming band of undead have come through a portal from the Shadowfell. The authorities know about this because they have regular scrying spells setup around the town. Breaches from the Shadowfell like this are quite common, and the populace is kept unaware. The undead that come through are typically marauders that kill everything in their path. The goal is to stop them before they have a chance to do some damage or their trail goes cold.

Task 1 – Find the Portal: The scrying spell provides the general location of the last portal opened. Further rituals or craft are necessary to narrow down on the actual location. If successful, you find the portal location and are ready to head there.

Task 1 Challenge

Skills:	Arcana, Religion -2
Type:	Representative
Complex:	4 successes before 4 failures
DC:	By quest level

Results	Effects
4 S, 0 F	Task Success. Secondary skill +2.
4 S, 1 F	Task Success.
4 S, 2 F	Task Success. Delay by 1.
4 S, 3 F	Task Success. Secondary skill -2.
3 S, 4 F	Task Failed. Retry any skill.
2 S, 4 F	Task Failed. Retry other skill.
1 S, 4 F	Quest Failed.
0 S, 4 F	Quest Failed. Delay by 2.

Task 2 –Track the Undead: At the portal location you pick up the undeads' tracks. They move slowly, so you should be able to catch up to them.

Task 2 Challenge

Skills:	Perception, Nature -2
Type:	Representative
Complex:	4 successes before 4 failures
DC:	By quest level

Results	Effects
4 S, 0 F	Task Success. Skip next task.
4 S, 1 F	Task Success. Primary skill +2.
4 S, 2 F	Task Success. Secondary skill +2.
4 S, 3 F	Task Success.
3 S, 4 F	Task Failed. Retry any skill.
2 S, 4 F	Task Failed. Retry other skill.
1 S, 4 F	Quest Failed.
0 S, 4 F	Quest Failed. Delay by 2.

Task 3 – Run Ahead: You track the group of undead and find them. Thankfully they've not had the chance to find and destroy a house yet. Now it seems the best strategy is to run ahead of them and cut them off at the pass.

Task 3 Challenge

Skills:	Athletics, Endurance -2
Type:	Representative
Complexity:	4 successes before 4 failures
DC:	By quest level

Results	**Effects**
4 S, 0 F	Task Success. Both skills +2.
4 S, 1 F	Task Success. Secondary skill +2.
4 S, 2 F	Task Success.
4 S, 3 F	Task Success. Delay by 1.
3 S, 4 F	Task Failed. Retry any skill.
2 S, 4 F	Task Failed. Retry other skill.
1 S, 4 F	Quest Failed.
0 S, 4 F	Quest Failed. Delay by 2.

Task 4 – Encounter: The monster ally group is undead_roamer. The terrain is the biome of the settlement.

Battle Vestige

Prologue: Another, more powerful, party has vanquished a great foe and is the toast of the kingdom! However, in the hubbub they left without completely wiping out the villain's forces. It falls upon you to return to the villain's base and clean up any monsters left over. The villain was a potent necromancer, and their minions were undead.

Task 1 – Meet the Heroes: The great heroes barely have time for you amidst the celebration of their victory. They don't take you seriously, so you'll have to show them that you are a force to be reckoned with. If successful, they'll tell you were the enemy's base is. Any minions that are left will be found inside the base, whether a tower or a dungeon.

Task 1 Challenge

Skills:	Intimidate, Bluff -2
Type:	Representative
Complex:	4 successes before 4 failures
DC:	By quest level

Results	Effects
4 S, 0 F	Task Success. Skip next task.
4 S, 1 F	Task Success. Both skills +2.
4 S, 2 F	Task Success. Primary skill +2.
4 S, 3 F	Task Success. Secondary skill +2.
3 S, 4 F	Task Failed. Retry any skill.
2 S, 4 F	Task Failed. Retry other skill.
1 S, 4 F	Quest Failed.
0 S, 4 F	Quest Failed. Delay by 2.

Task 2 – Avoid Traps: The base has been broken into and parts are still smoldering. You'll have to make your way around some traps to get to the minions inside.

Task 2 Challenge

Skills:	Acrobatics, Thievery -2
Type:	Representative
Complex:	4 successes before 4 failures
DC:	By quest level

Results	Effects
4 S, 0 F	Task Success. Secondary skill +2.
4 S, 1 F	Task Success.
4 S, 2 F	Task Success. Delay by 1.
4 S, 3 F	Task Success. Secondary skill -2.
3 S, 4 F	Task Failed. Retry any skill.
2 S, 4 F	Task Failed. Retry other skill.
1 S, 4 F	Quest Failed.
0 S, 4 F	Quest Failed. Delay by 2.

Task 3 –Search Interior: You'll have to use your knowledge of architecture and secret passages to find where the leftover minions are.

Task 3 Challenge

Skills:	Dungeoneering, Perception -2
Type:	Representative
Complexity:	4 successes before 4 failures
DC:	By quest level

Results	**Effects**
4 S, 0 F	Task Success. Secondary skill +2.
4 S, 1 F	Task Success.
4 S, 2 F	Task Success. Delay by 1.
4 S, 3 F	Task Success. Secondary skill -2.
3 S, 4 F	Task Failed. Retry any skill.
2 S, 4 F	Task Failed. Retry other skill.
1 S, 4 F	Quest Failed.
0 S, 4 F	Quest Failed. Delay by 2.

Task 4 – Encounter: The monster ally group is undead_denizen. The terrain is any underground.

Skill Plot Ideas

Bluff

- Win at a game of cards to make some new contacts.
- Pose as someone else and get the enemies to reveal things.
- Get information from someone that you don't trust.

Diplomacy

- Attend a noble's party to gather information.
- Use etiquette to pass off as a noble.

Insight

- Question a witness or a culprit to get at what they know.
- Psycho-analyze a subject to get at their base motivations.

Intimidate

- Interrogate a prisoner or an accomplice about their group.
- Influence the attitude of people towards you, or against.

Streetwise

- Hit the town for the latest gossip.

Arcana

- Use a spell to find a certain object within the settlement.
- Use a spell to remote view a certain location that you have awareness of.

Heal

- Analyze and interpret a crime scene or domicile.
- Provide emergency aid to refugees or released captives.

History

- Create a quick map of a settlement or an estate.
- Engineer a siege tower, catapult, chariot, or boat.
- Win at a prestigious board game to earn respect and favors.

Religion

- Interpret an omen from the gods.
- Recall a myth that resembles the current situation.

Dungeoneering

- Search for the territory of an aberrant or elemental.
- Collect clues from the physical landscape of a city, or a cave.
- Dig your way into some place.

Nature

- Search for the territory of a certain animal species.
- Use your knowledge of nature to earn trust.

Perception

- Track humanoids and animals in the wilderness.
- Search for the thing that stands out, and maybe get a clue.

Stealth

- Find the best place for a stake-out, or an ambush.
- Travel a short distance in wilderness with camouflage.

Acrobatics

- Win at axe throwing to get people to trust you.
- Dance for entertainment.
- Balance on a ledge, throw a grappling hook.

Athletics

- Do physical labor that requires short bursts, like sprinting or lifting.
- Break down a window or door.
- Climb up through an unlikely path.

Endurance

- Do physical labor that requires continuous effort - pulling, hammering, rowing.
- Win a drinking contest to be sociable.

Thievery

- Break into the enemy hide-out.
- Steal something that gives you an advantage.

CHAPTER FOUR

DUNGEON CRAWL

OVERVIEW

A dungeon is an automated major quest. It starts in a hallway that leads to two rooms. The party explores that hallway and gains clues that help them decide which room to go to. In a room there is a combat with monsters in the theme of the dungeon. After the encounter, the party gets a chance to recover. The party then enters another hallway and the cycle continues. The party can go through as many rooms as they wish, and once they exit the dungeon they might get magic items.

Dungeon: A dungeon has a level, a list of monster ally groups, a language, and a landmark on the region map. It also has a series of hallways and rooms, as well as treasure chests – however the party must discover those as part of the adventure.

Level: The level of the dungeon sets the baseline for the level of encounters, challenges, and rewards in the dungeon. The level of the dungeon becomes known when the party acquires the dungeon map.

Ally Groups: A dungeon has a set of monster ally groups, which may include 1 or more ally groups. The ally groups are used to generate the monsters of the dungeon.

Language: A dungeon has a language associated with it because it's built by a culture, whether ancient or current. The languages are: Abyssal, Common, Draconic, Dwarven, Elven, Deep Speech, Giant, Goblin, Primordial, Supernal. Knowing the dungeon's language gives a character two rules:

- They get a Skill +2 bonus to any Exploration Challenges they do.
- They may assist with any Exploration Challenges. This is an exception and does not require them to be trained in any of the challenge's skills.

Landmark: The map to the dungeon, or spoken instructions, can lead anyone to the vicinity of the dungeon's entrance. The entrance is a landmark on the region map. The DM creates this landmark when the dungeon becomes available.

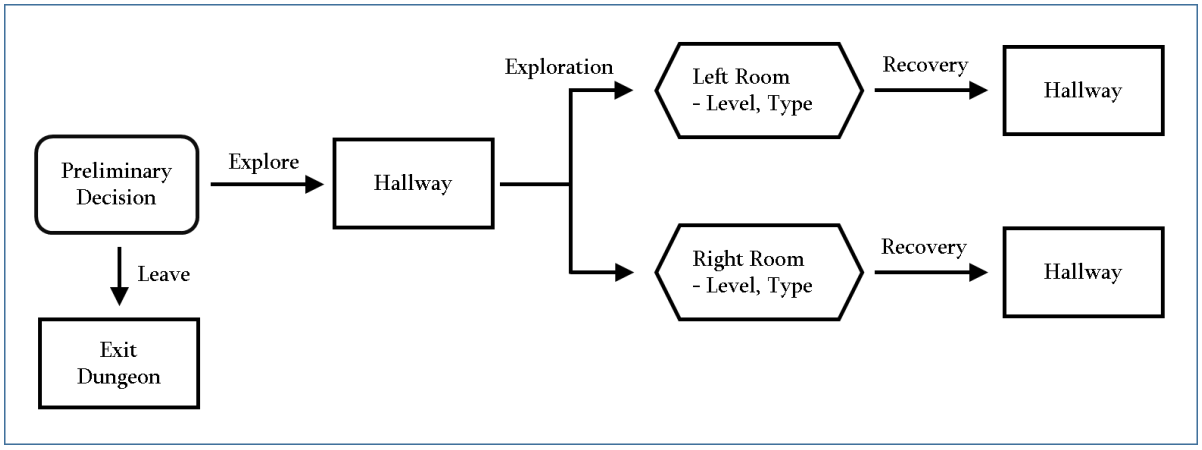
Hallway: The hallway is the first abstraction of the dungeon traversal. It represents the party moving along the paths of the dungeon, carefully and keeping track of themselves. A hallway leads to two separate rooms – aptly named the left and right rooms.

Room: The room is the second abstraction of the dungeon traversal. It represents the journey coming to a head and combat breaking out. It also represents the party moving on to collect themselves. Typically in a room the party has an encounter, however not all rooms have an encounter. After the encounter the party may rest. A room leads into the next hallway, and returning to its hallway is not possible.

How To Traverse: The party starts in a hallway and has two options: explore the hallway, or leave the dungeon. To explore use the "Explore Hallway" party action. To leave use the "Exit Dungeon" action. Exploring a hallway forces the party to go into one of the rooms and use the "Engage Room" action. If the room has an encounter, the party gets to rest. The party then exits the room and goes to the next hallway. The cycle continues until the party arrives at a hallway and decides to leave the dungeon.

Objective: A dungeon is an indefinitely running quest. That is, the party will continue to explore it until they leave or they die. Also, the party gets dungeon completion rewards for every 3 encounters, as explained in the "Exit Dungeon" action. Therefore, the objective is to play as many encounters as possible without getting killed.

Dungeon Schematic



Party Actions

Explore Hallway

Requirements

- The party is in a dungeon hallway and chooses to explore it.
- It takes 1 time block.

Explore Hallway: To explore a hallway, follow these steps.

1] Create Hallway: The DM creates the hallway and the two adjoining rooms. The hallway has a flavor which sets the skill used to explore it. Each room has an encounter type and a level. The room information is unknown by the party.

Hallway Flavor

Roll 2d6	Exploration Skill
2 – 5	Acrobatics
6 – 7	Athletics
8 – 9	Endurance
10 – 12	Thievery

Room Type & Level

Roll 2d6	Type
2 – 5	None
6 – 8	Combat
9 – 12	Double Jeopardy

Roll 2d8	Level
2 – 5	Dungeon Level -1
6 – 8	Dungeon Level +0
9 – 11	Dungeon Level +1
12 – 16	Dungeon Level +2

2] Exploration Challenge: The party makes an Exploration Challenge to get clues about the rooms. On success, the party gets some information and bonuses related to the rooms. On failure, the party still gets some information, but also suffers some setbacks. When rolling exploration clues, each clue for each room cannot repeat. When such a clue is rolled twice, re-roll it.

Exploration Challenge

Skills:	By hallway type
Type:	Representative
Complex:	3 successes before 3 failures
DC:	By dungeon level
Faction:	Militia

Exploration Results

Results	Effect
3 S, 0 F	Roll 6 exploration clues.
3 S, 1 F	Roll 4 exploration clues.
3 S, 2 F	Roll 2 exploration clues.
2 S, 3 F	Promote a random room to a Double Jeopardy.
1 S, 3 F	Promote both rooms to a Double Jeopardy.
0 S, 3 F	Increase level by 1 for both rooms.

Exploration Clue

Roll 1d4	Room
1 – 2	Left
3 – 4	Right

Roll 1d8	Clue
1	Decrease room's level by 1.
2	Decrease room's number of monsters by 1.
3	Demote room from DJ to Combat.
4	The party gets awareness "Prepared" for the room.
5	The party learns the type of the room.
6	The party learns the level of the room.
7	Skill +5 bonus to Recovery in the room.
8	Re-roll.

3] Move To Room: The party must move into one of the rooms. The incomplete information provided by the exploration challenge can help the party decide which room to go to.

Engage Room

Room Type: This party action has different rules based on the room type. However, the rooms do share some rules, like the combat monster entries.

Type – None: Type none means there is no encounter. The party does not get a chance to rest. They move on to the next preliminary decision. This room type takes no time blocks.

Type – Combat: Combat means a combat is played out as described ahead. After the combat, the party goes on to recovery. This room type takes 1 time block.

Type – Double Jeopardy: To start a DJ, the party plays an encounter as normal. Then, at the end of combat, after looting but before resting, the DM makes a check. The DM rolls a 50% chance of there being an extra encounter. When there is an extra encounter, the party first takes a short rest, then plays the encounter. The extra encounter follows the normal rules for combat and recovery. When there isn't an extra encounter, the party just goes to recovery. This room type takes 1 time block.

Combat: The party faces a normal combat encounter. The level of the encounter is the level of the room. The monster group is generated using the dungeon's ally groups.

Recovery: There are special rules for resting in a dungeon, since it's a dangerous and inhospitable place. To rest the party rolls a Recovery Challenge to see what kind of rest they can get before being forced to move on. After resting, the party goes back to the preliminary decision.

If the party rolls an extended rest and their extended rest's cooldown has not yet reset, then the extended rest is reduced to a short rest. When this happens, the party still benefits from the extra time blocks. Note that in the MGX the extended rest cooldown is increased to 18 hours, or 6 time blocks.

Recovery Challenge

Skills:	Stealth, Heal
Type:	Representative
Complexity:	2 successes before 2 failures
DC:	By dungeon level
Faction:	Shadow

Recovery Results

Results	Effects
2 S, 0 F	Extended Rest, choose 2-3 time blocks.
2 S, 1 F	Extended Rest, 2 time blocks.
1 S, 2 F	Short Rest.
0 S, 2 F	Short Rest, but each character can only spend 1 healing surge.

EXIT DUNGEON

Requirements:

- It takes a number of time blocks equal to the number of encounters met in the dungeon.

Rewards: When the party leaves the dungeon, they are effectively turning in the quest. The party receives 1 treasure chest and 1 XP award per 3 encounters won in the dungeon. If 2 or less encounters were won, then no extra awards are given.

Treasure Chest: The treasure chest is a magic vendor inventory that the party can choose items from. The inventory is generated as normal, except that its level is the level of the dungeon, and there are 2 items per character in the party. Each character chooses and keeps 1 item from the chest. The remaining items are discarded.

XP Award: Each character gets an XP award. The base value of the award is equal to the XP value of a monster of the dungeon's level (aka Q-XP). The total value is the base value times a factor given by a Lifeline Challenge.

Lifeline Challenge

Skills:	Str, Dex, Con, Int, Wis, Cha
Type:	Individual
Complexity:	2 successes before 2 failures
DC:	By dungeon level
Special:	Has dungeon language: roll +2

Results	Effects
2 S, 0 F	Q-XP x 100%
2 S, 1 F	Q-XP x 75%
1 S, 2 F	Q-XP x 50%
0 S, 2 F	Q-XP x 25%

CHAPTER FIVE

ADVENTURE MODULE

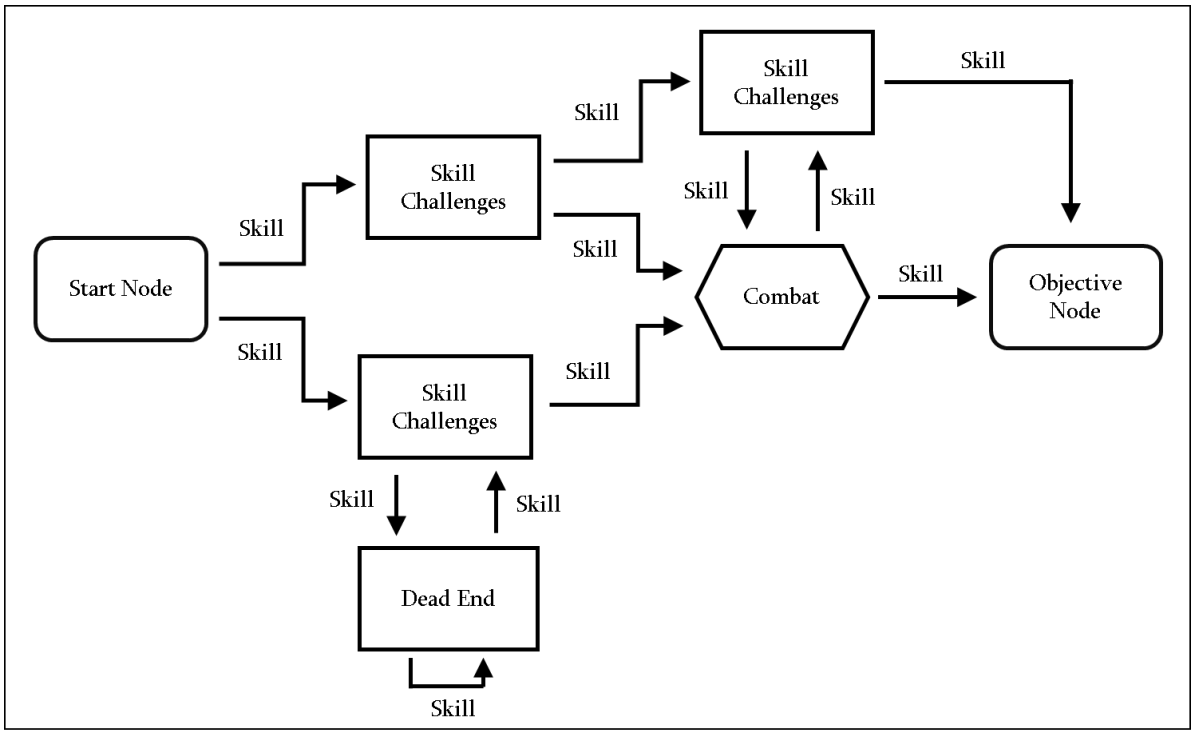
OVERVIEW

The adventure module is a major quest with a complex plot. Instead of the PCs being on rails like in the bounties, dungeon, or most other pre-made RPG adventures, the module provides different paths to completing the objectives. It gives the DM a framework with which to build a fully-fledged adventure of their own.

Adventure: An adventure has many properties including a name, level, faction, villain, plot points, small awards, objective, etc. The DM creates this information with the "World Builder's Guide" and keeps most of it hidden from the party. Instead, the party has a quest giver, and enough leads to get started. Often, the party does not have a clear objective when they start. They must follow along the plot by investigating, talking, fighting, and finding clues that lead them to the objective. The party can sometimes get lost or side-tracked, and they should avoid this because there's a time limit to meet the objective. Many adventures have more than one objective, and the party is rewarded for every objective they can win.

Plot Node: An adventure is modeled as a series of *plot nodes* that are interconnected. A node is a plot abstraction that represents a point in space and time pertaining to the party's path in the adventure. More loosely speaking, it's comparable with a scene in a movie. A plot node has 1 or more skills that when successfully used unlock effects for that node. This can lead to the path to a next node, a small reward, a dead end, a quest objective, etc. A plot node can also have an encounter, which happens before any skill challenges can be made. Therefore, the party moves from one node to the next, always searching for the next objective.

Adventure Schematic



Adventure Actions: The party begins the adventure by entering one of its starting nodes. While in a node, the party uses the "Explore Node" action to interact with it. The party may leave the node to do something not related to the adventure, like rest or stock up on items. They can return to any previous node that they've been to. However any effects that are time-sensitive will no longer be available. To turn in the adventure, leave the current node and run the "Quest Turn-in" action.

For example, the party goes to a node where they meet a blacksmith that is the relative of one of the victims in their quest. The question him, get what they need, and move on to the next node. Sometime later they realize they might have missed something and want to go back to the blacksmith. They go back, but now they find that the blacksmith is missing, as mysteriously as the other victims. So physically they can go back to the blacksmith shop, but time-wise talking to the blacksmith is no longer available.

For Example: The party learns from Marion, a well-known local, that the nearby village of Algeria has been raided by orcs which are now occupying it. The initial clues are that the adventure is level 5, the faction is Commoner, orcs are the villain, and that they can get started by going to the village. The party decides to do the quest, so they travel by road to get to Algeria.

Upon arriving they are at the adventure's starting node. The DM describes how the town is deserted, they can't see or hear anything out of the ordinary. And upon closer inspection, the party finds a scene that has some blood and looks like a battle happened. Knowing that Heal can be used as forensics, one of the characters attempts a Heal check. It turns out that no useful information can be gained with that. Another character thinks he can track the orcs going away from the scene and attempts a Perception check. He succeeds and the party follows the tracks to the next plot node.

Party Actions

Explore Node

In an adventure plot node the party must roll a skill challenge in order to find the path to the next node. The skill challenge may reveal other things also, like small awards or a quest clue. The trick however is that the skills used are unknown to the party. The party must use information they've gathered in the course of the adventure to make their best guess about what skill to try.

Requirements:

- The party is in an adventure plot node.
- It takes 1 time block.

Node Skills: Each node is unique and has its own logic. The skills that can be used to reveal a node's effect are that node's *on-skills*. Skills that cannot be used in a node are the *off-skills*. A node typically has 2 to 3 on-skills, however 0 or 5 can also occur. Sometimes many skills reveal the same effect.

Explore: To explore the node, a character chooses a skill and declares they're using it. The player then describes what they are doing, and maybe why they think it'll work. They can create any scenario, as long as it stays within the bounds of the adventure and the setting. The DM then reveals whether the skill chosen by the player is an on-skill or an off-skill. The player then rolls the skill challenge on the corresponding table ahead.

Exploration Challenge

Skills:	Best guess
Type:	Representative
Complex:	3 successes before 3 failures
DC:	By quest level

On-Skill Results

Results	Effect
3 S, 0 F	Task Success. Gain 1 quest clue.
3 S, 1 F	Task Success. One other on-skill is revealed.
3 S, 2 F	Task Success.
2 S, 3 F	Task Failure.
1 S, 3 F	Task Failure. Extend time blocks by 1.
0 S, 3 F	Task Failure. Extend time blocks by 2.

Off-Skill Results

Results	Effect
3 S, 0 F	All on-skills are revealed.
3 S, 1 F	One on-skill is revealed.
3 S, 2 F	Skill +2 to the next skill challenge in this node.
2 S, 3 F	No effects.
1 S, 3 F	Extend time blocks by 1.
0 S, 3 F	Extend time blocks by 2.

Exploration Effects

Task Failure: The task did not go right and is a waste of time. The party can retry the same node as many times as they like. However, for each skill retried at a node, that skills gets a cumulative -1 penalty.

Task Success: The on-skill used is successful and reveals a sweet effect. If an effect has already been revealed, it's skills can no longer be used in the node.

Quest Clue: The party gains a *quest clue* when they have spectacular success with a skill challenge. The quest clue can be used any time the party wants to. Though it's use must be declared before any of the relevant rolls have been made. Also, the user tells the story of how this clue actually helps this challenge. It can be used for the following.

- For combat setup rolls, a skill +5 bonus.
- For a skill challenge, a skill +2 bonus.

Quest Turn-In

Requirements:

- The party must have returned to the quest giver.
- It takes 1 time block.

Rewards: The party receives 1 treasure chest and 1 XP award per objective that was won.

Treasure Chest: The treasure chest is a magic vendor inventory that the party can choose items from. The inventory is generated as normal, except that its level is the level of the quest, and there are 2 items per character in the party. Each character chooses and keeps 1 item from the chest. The remaining items are discarded.

XP Award: Each character gets an XP award. The base value of the award is equal to the XP value of a monster of the quest's level (aka Q-XP). The total value is the base times a factor given by a Lifeline Challenge.

Lifeline Challenge

Skills:	Str, Dex, Con, Int, Wis, Cha
Type:	Individual
Complexity:	2 successes before 2 failures
DC:	By quest level

Results	**Effects**
2 S, 0 F	Q-XP x 100%
2 S, 1 F	Q-XP x 75%
1 S, 2 F	Q-XP x 50%
0 S, 2 F	Q-XP x 25%